Nishal Stanislaus Silva, *PhD*

Machine Learning Engineer | Evaluation Frameworks, LLM & Multimodal Systems, Real-Time ML | PhD

Canadian Permanent Resident, Eligible to work in Canada without sponsorship

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5th November 2026

Re: Senior Machine Learning Engineer / Applied Scientist - Microsoft (Vancouver, BC)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Machine Learning Engineer / Applied Scientist role at Microsoft in Vancouver. I am a machine learning engineer and researcher with a PhD from the University of Trento (2025) and 10+ years across industry and academia, with evaluation design and production deployment at the centre of my work. My most recent published system made real-time decisions in 14 ms on a Raspberry Pi 4 at F1 0.76, 74× faster than the DTW baseline it replaced (JAES 2026).

Here is how my work maps to the role:

- **Evaluation frameworks and offline experimentation.** I design benchmark suites with baselines, ablations and error analysis. My latest harness scores 6 methods over 100,000 trials (best ROC-AUC 0.822 vs. 0.599 baseline), and I released four open datasets (9,800+ recordings, 70+ musicians) so others can reproduce the results.
- **Production-grade ML.** On the EU-funded MUSMET project I owned the pipeline for streaming multimodal data from acquisition to deployment, with <30 ms inference at >90% F1, monitoring and reproducible documentation. At MAS Holdings I deployed ML and computer-vision systems into manufacturing, improving operational efficiency by up to 300%, and introduced CI/CD and code review.
- **Multimodal systems and LLM tooling.** I built a real-time sync pipeline over audio, EEG and head/hand tracking across 4 musicians, and I use LLMs, RAG and Claude Code in my daily workflow, including for experiment iteration.

To be direct about the gaps: my hands-on LLM, RAG and agent work is at the application and tooling level, not on a shipped LLM product, and I have not worked on a consumer product team with live user-facing experiments. My strengths are evaluation rigor, latency-constrained deployment and ownership from prototype to monitoring, and I would apply them to grounding, reliability and failure analysis for LLM systems.

I am a Canadian permanent resident, eligible to work in Canada without sponsorship, available immediately, willing to relocate to Vancouver, and able to pass the Microsoft Cloud background check. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can help the Applied Sciences team.

Sincerely,

Nishal Stanislaus Silva, PhD